



Analytics & Big Data

Session 10: Analytics in organizations

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(2026-05-11)

Learning objectives

- **Explain** the strategic role of data analytics in data-driven organizations.
- **Discuss** the ethical and legal boundaries of data analytics in organizations.

Industry-level perspectives

Does the deployment of analytics pay off?

Müller et al. (2018): The Effect of Big Data and Analytics on Firm Performance

The study examines whether firms with live **big data and analytics (BDA) assets** show higher productivity than comparable firms without such assets.

Empirical setting

- 814 publicly traded firms
- 2008–2014 panel data
- 5,698 firm-year observations
- Objective data on live BDA assets
- Financial data from Compustat

Outcome and controls

- Outcome: $\log(Sales)$
- Inputs: labor, capital, materials
- Controls: General IT, industry, and year
- Moderators: IT intensity and competition

$$\log(Sales) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \log(Labor) + \beta_2 \log(Capital) + \beta_3 \log(Materials) + \beta_4 BDA + Controls + \varepsilon$$



	OLS	FE
log(Capital)	0.090*** (0.015)	0.127*** (0.029)
log(Labor)	0.296*** (0.024)	0.472*** (0.043)
log(Materials)	0.667*** (0.023)	0.442*** (0.035)
BDA	0.041** (0.020)	0.038* (0.021)
Industry dummies?	Yes	Yes
Year dummies?	Yes	Yes
IT Asset dummies?	Yes	Yes
Observations	5,698	5,698
R^2	0.977	0.791
Adjusted R^2	0.977	0.755

Key findings and implications

- **Analytics assets alone are insufficient:** value depends on complementary resources such as data infrastructure, enterprise systems, and analytical skills.
- **Industry conditions matter:** IT-intensive and highly competitive industries show clearer productivity effects.
- **Causality remains difficult:** observational firm-level data can reduce, but not fully eliminate, concerns about reverse causality and omitted variables.

At the industry level, analytics deployment should be understood as part of a broader configuration of digital capabilities, competitive pressure, and organizational capacity to turn data into decisions.

A meta-analysis



Oesterreich et al. (2022): What translates big data into business value?

This meta-analysis examines how differences in **business analytics (BA) resources, capabilities, and contextual factors** are associated with differences in firm performance.

Empirical setting



- 125 firm-level studies
- 123 articles
- 2012–2021 research period
- 26 countries, four continents
- 358 effect sizes
- Quantitative synthesis through meta-analysis

Meta-analysis results



Independent variable	n	N	Estimated effect	95% CI	Heterogeneity
BA technical resources	91	39,246	0.452	0.409–0.493	Q = 1920.153**, df = 90, I ² = 95.31%
BA human resources	42	9,219	0.494	0.444–0.541	Q = 379.967**, df = 41, I ² = 89.21%
BA management capabilities	69	16,074	0.477	0.433–0.519	Q = 861.169**, df = 68, I ² = 92.10%
Data quality	14	3,088	0.434	0.328–0.528	Q = 142.257**, df = 13, I ² = 90.86%
Organizational culture	18	3,698	0.472	0.391–0.546	Q = 153.939**, df = 17, I ² = 88.96%
External pressure	17	3,644	0.165	0.036–0.288	Q = 248.937**, df = 16, I ² = 93.57%

Key findings and implications

- BA is positively associated with firm performance across studies.
- The strongest effects are linked to **human resources, management capabilities, and organizational culture**.
- Technical resources and data quality matter, but they do not explain value creation alone.
- External pressure shows a smaller effect.
- High heterogeneity indicates that BA value creation remains context-dependent.

Organizational perspectives

A process perspective



Kunz et al. (2025): Process-level value creation from business analytics

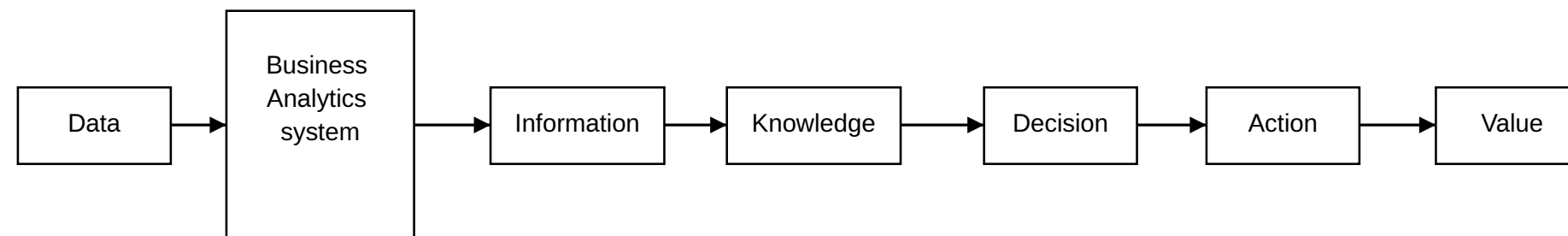
This theoretical literature review examines **how business analytics creates value in organizational processes** and how **machine learning changes these value-creation paths**.

Research focus

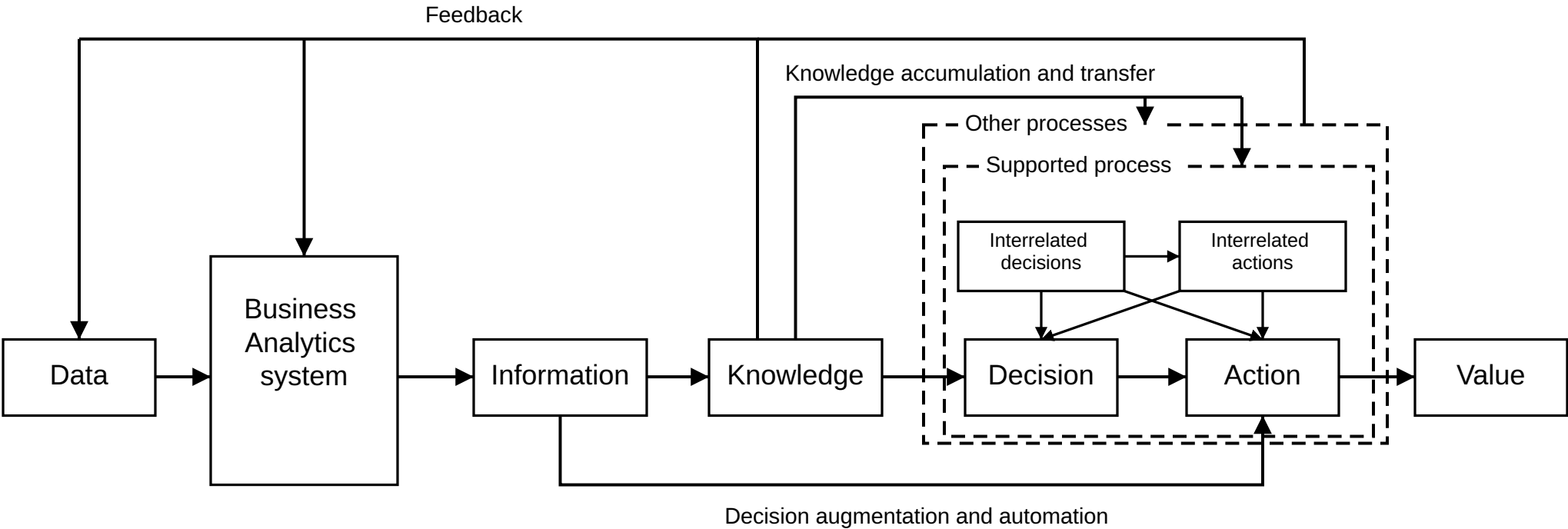
- Process-level value creation
- Business analytics systems in use
- Organizational decision-making
- Knowledge creation and use
- Effects of ML-based analytics

Method and evidence base

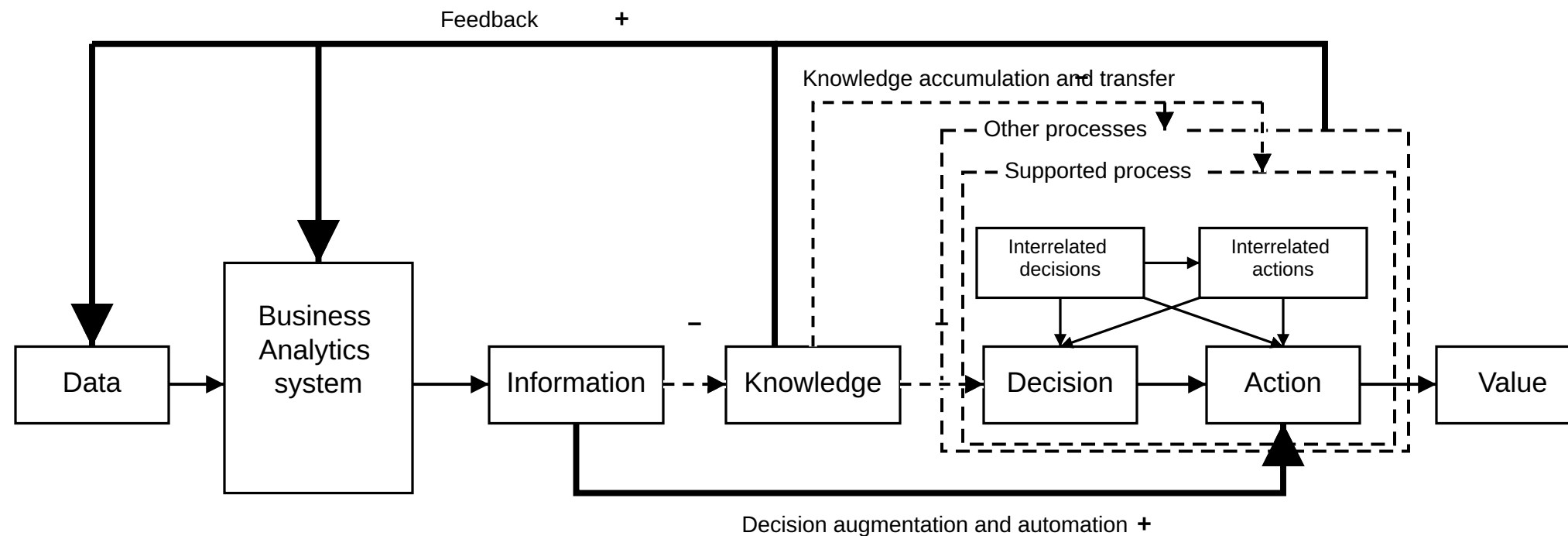
- Theoretical literature review
- Emergent theory building
- 176 articles synthesized
- Information Value Chain as sensitizing lens
- Six value-creation paths identified



Value creation paths



How machine learning changes value creation



- **Autonomy** leads to a stronger reliance on analytical information for decision-making and action
- **Dynamism** involves knowledge and data-driven feedback to improve the ground truth or the analytical system
- **Opacity** refers to the inscrutability of machine learning models, which restricts human understanding and process improvement

Towards a mature analytics portfolio

The **TDWI Analytics Maturity Model** offers a diagnostic framework for assessing analytics capabilities across organization, resources, data infrastructure, analytics, and governance.

The model classifies analytics maturity into five stages:

- **Nascent → Early → Established → Mature → Advanced/Visionary**

TDWI’s model supports a structured assessment of where an organization’s analytics portfolio currently stands and where further development may be needed.

Organizational Maturity	Resource Maturity	Data Infrastructure Maturity	Analytics Maturity	Governance Maturity
• Leadership • Culture • Impact • Strategy	• Funding • Talent/skills • Roles/ responsibilities • Training	• Diversity, volume, and speed • Data access • Data integration and management • Data architecture	• Scope of capabilities • Automation/ augmented • Deployment and delivery approaches • Innovation	• Data governance processes and tooling • Model governance processes and tooling • Governance roles • Security/privacy

Based on Halper (2020)

Responsible deployment: Analytics and AI risk management



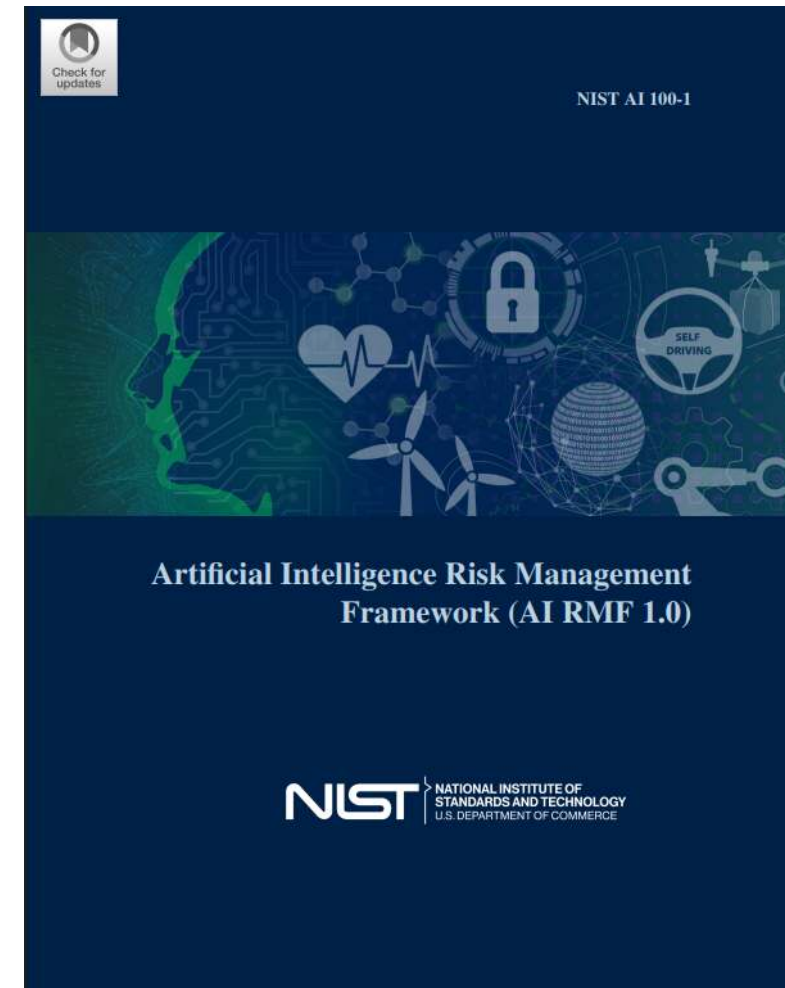
Advanced analytics increasingly becomes part of **AI systems** when it informs, recommends, or automates consequential decisions.

NIST AI Risk Management Framework

- **Govern:** roles, policies, accountability
- **Map:** context, stakeholders, intended use
- **Measure:** performance, bias, robustness, risks
- **Manage:** mitigation, monitoring, incident response

Deployment questions

- Who is affected?
- What decision is supported or automated?
- What can go wrong?
- Who is accountable?
- How do we know when to stop or intervene?



The *GDPR* (Art. 15 and 22) and the *AI Act* (Art. 27 and 86) require organizations to support responsible use of consequential automated decisions: affected persons need meaningful information, human intervention and contestability, while deployers of high-risk AI systems need transparency, oversight, logging, and fundamental-rights assessments.

Boundaries: what should not be optimized?



Analytics creates value only within legitimate organizational, ethical, and legal boundaries.

Possible boundaries

- Privacy and purpose limitation
- Non-discrimination and fairness
- Safety and reliability
- Human autonomy and dignity
- Legal compliance
- Organizational values

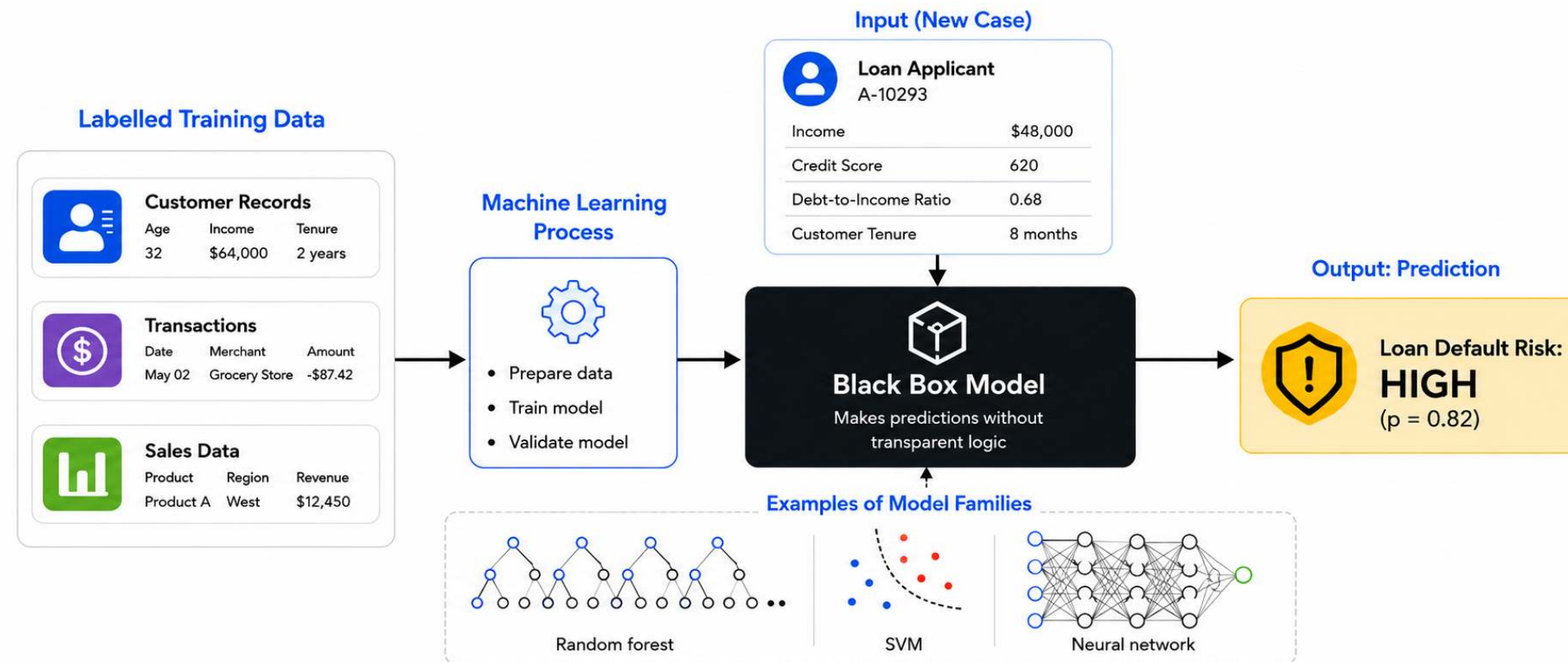
Examples

Use case	Boundary question
Employee analytics	Does this become surveillance?
Credit scoring	Who is disadvantaged?
Medical triage	What happens in edge cases?
Dynamic pricing	When is personalization exploitative?
Fraud detection	How are false positives handled?

The black box of modern analytics



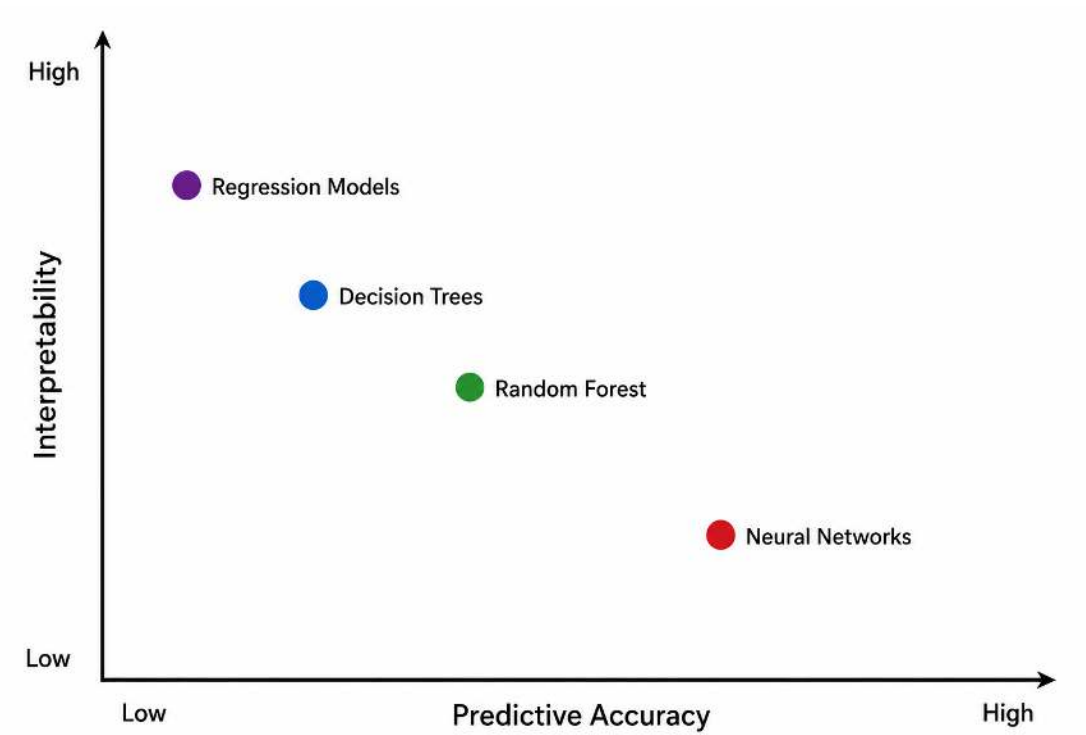
Modern analytics systems transform data into predictions without exposing a decision logic that people can easily inspect.



This raises practical questions:

- Why this prediction?
- Why not another prediction?
- When does the system fail?
- Who can contest or override it?

The need for interpretability



Interpretability is needed for different purposes

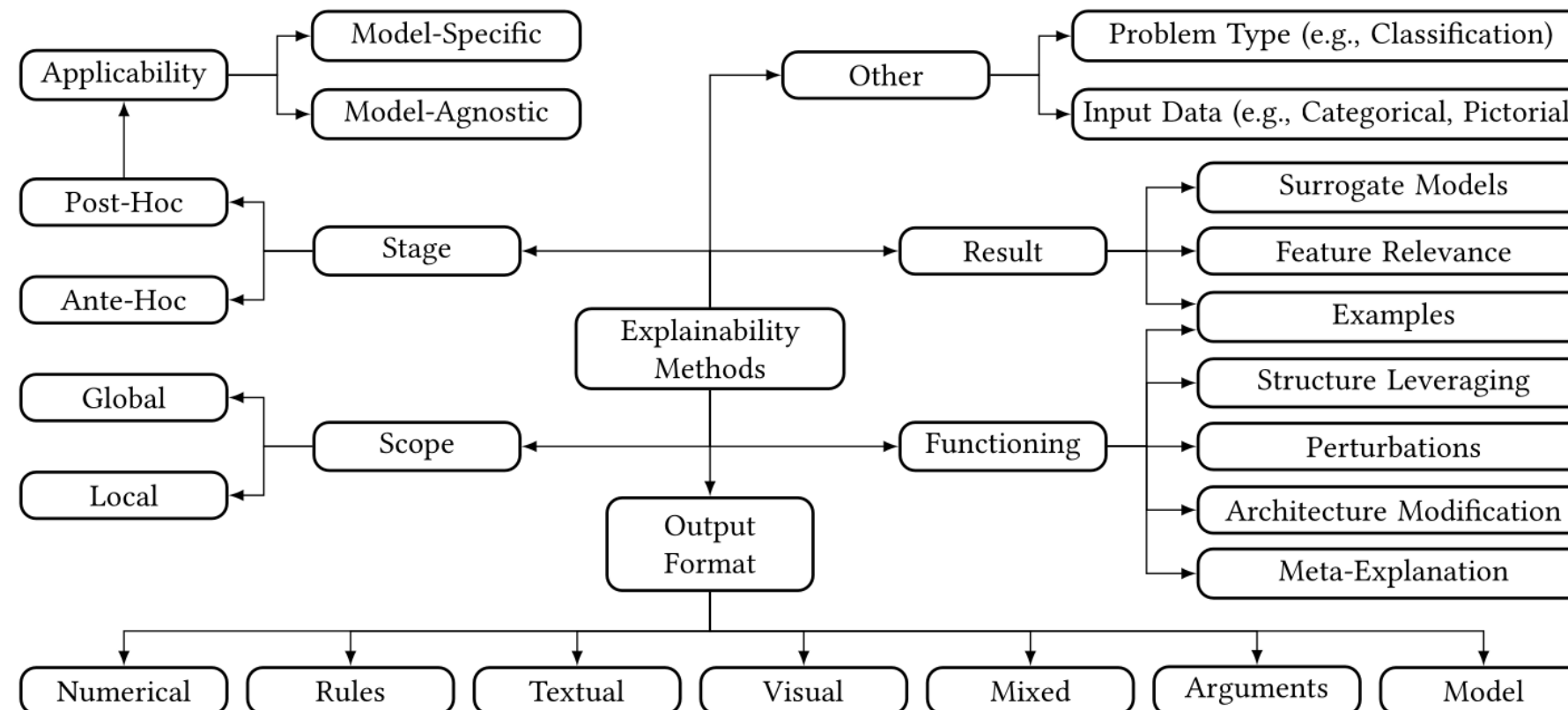
Context	Purpose
Trust	know when to rely on the output
Engineering	debug errors, bias, and brittle behavior
Governance	assign responsibility and define oversight
Recourse	understand, challenge, or improve an outcome
Regulation	document compliance and enable auditability

Based on Chamola et al. (2023)

Explainability methods

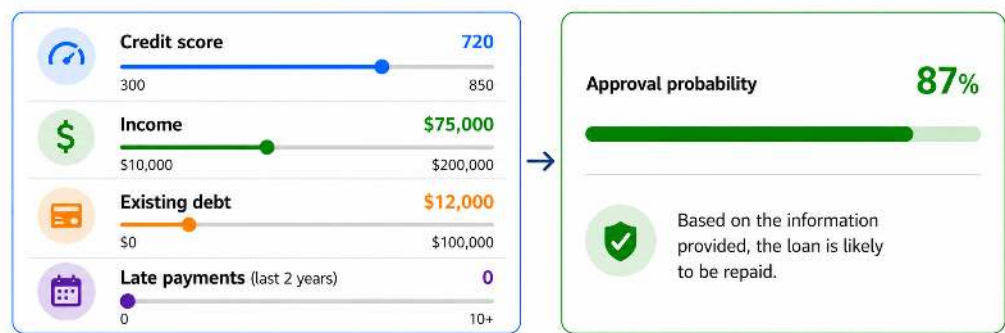
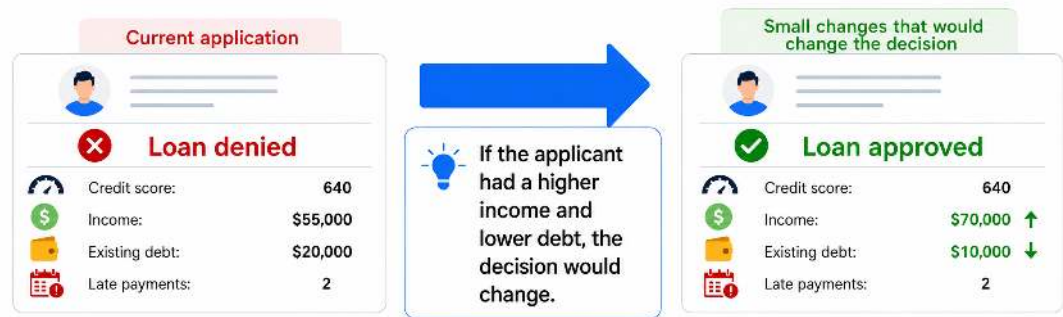


Explainability methods aim to make AI-based systems, their reasoning processes, or their outputs understandable, either by designing models that are explainable from the outset or by generating explanations for already-trained, potentially opaque models.



Based on Speith (2022)

Explainability methods: Examples



Feature importance

Mostly static analysis of the trained model and data; often post-hoc, though some models provide importance intrinsically. Usually provides a global view: which variables matter most across the model or dataset.

Counterfactual explanations

Post-hoc explanation based on minimal feature changes that would alter the prediction.

Interactive explanation

Post-hoc, user-driven exploration combining static explanations with what-if changes to input features.



People perspectives

Human resources for analytics

BCG AI Radar 2025 survey

- 1,803 C-level executives
- Across markets, industries, roles, and company sizes

Main finding:

AI is expected to reshape work more than eliminate workers.

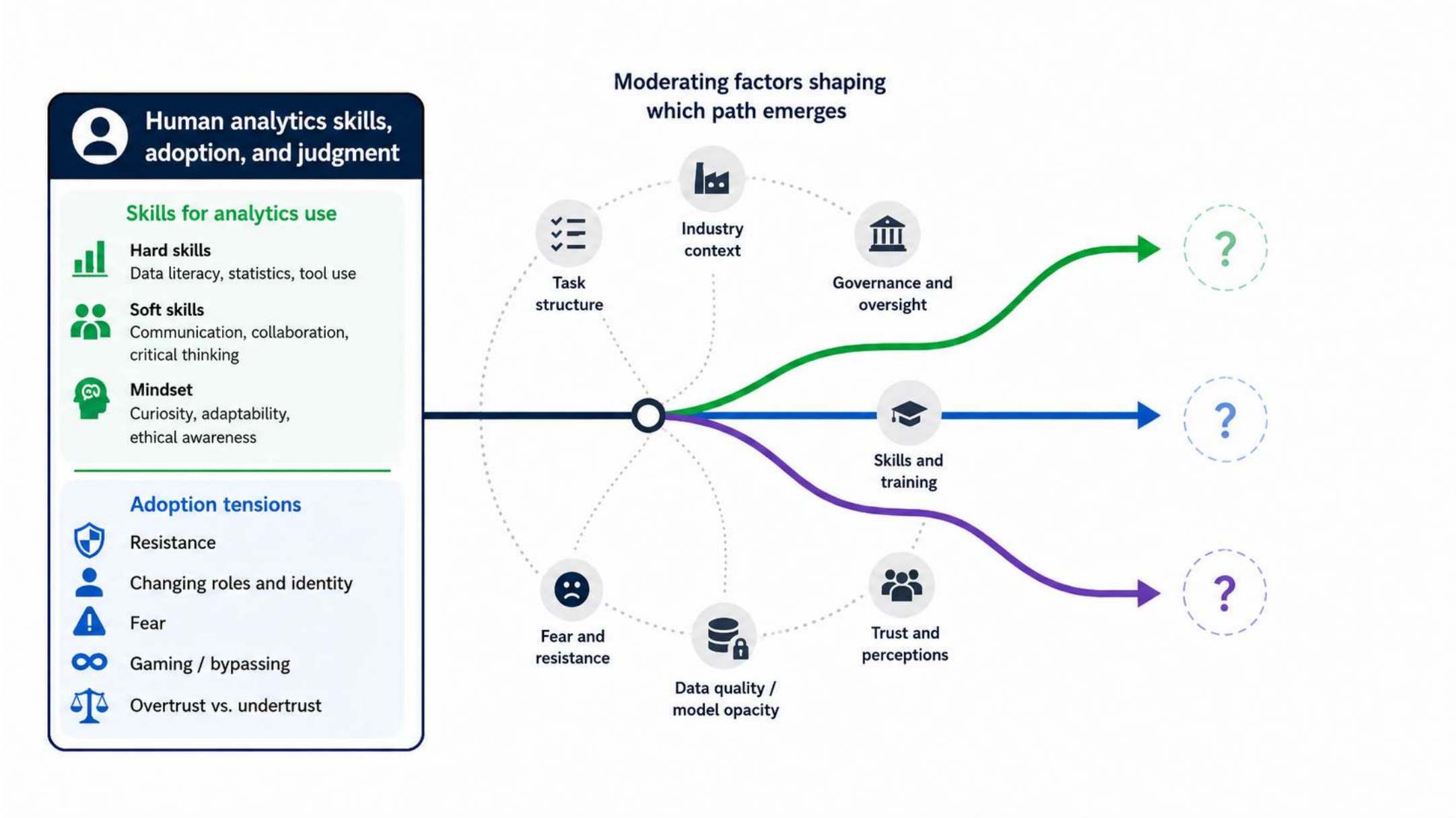
- Only 7% expect fewer FTEs due to automation
- 17% expect workforce restructuring with new roles
- 68% expect more productivity and upskilling of the existing workforce
- 8% expect more FTEs and new skills

Analytics and AI deployment is a **people-and-process transformation**: executives expect value to come from humans and AI working **side by side**, with human oversight remaining central.



Based on Apotheker et al. ([2025](#))

Possible human futures in analytics and AI



Summary



- Analytics can improve organizational performance, but its value depends on **context**, complementary resources, and how analytics is embedded in organizational processes.
- Value creation requires an analytics portfolio that combines **data infrastructure, technical and human resources, management capabilities**, and governance aligned with strategy.
- Responsible deployment means asking not only “Can we optimize this?” but also “Should we?” — defining ethical, legal, and organizational boundaries before systems go live.
- As analytics becomes more autonomous, dynamic, and opaque, organizations need interpretability, risk management, and oversight mechanisms that allow people to **understand, contest, and intervene**.
- The human role is changing rather than disappearing: analytics and AI create value when people have the skills, mindset, and organizational conditions to work effectively with them.

Survey: Session 10



<https://forms.gle/Rhr4C47jsAZJyumN6>

Note: Responses may be analyzed and published in anonymized form.

Please complete the survey before you leave today — thank you 🙏

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